

SNIPPETS

- SEZ import exemptions set to accelerate India's chipmaking ambitions
- Qualcomm eyes AI expansion with ByteDance chip deal
- Tamil Nadu inks a semiconductor deal with MinebeaMitsumi
- Nvidia joins the Windows PC race as AI computing heats up
- Netrasemi set to begin mass production of first AI chip in 2026
- ISM announces investor support portal to support the semiconductor industry
- Nexperia announces partnership with Polar Semiconductor
- Infineon and Siemens partner on SiC-based circuit protection

\$500 million valuation. The funding will boost R&D and semiconductor testing facilities in India. Following its acquisition of Kinetic Technologies, Cyient aims to expand power-management chip solutions for AI-driven applications.

AGNIT announces advanced testing lab at IISc

AGNIT Semiconductor has launched a ₹30 million advanced testing lab at the Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru, to strengthen India's high-power RF and GaN semiconductor ecosystem. The 350 sq.ft. (32.5 sq.metres) facility supports in-house testing, validation, and product qualification, with plans for military-grade capabilities. AGNIT aims to scale production to 100,000 chips within 24 months and has raised \$7.47 million so far.

Nvidia's Q1 FY27 revenue jumps 85% amid AI boom

Nvidia reported record Q1 FY2027 revenue of \$81.6 billion, up 85% year-on-year, driven by its data centre business, which generated \$75.2 billion. Net income surged 211% to \$58.3 billion, while gross margins reached 75%. Nvidia returned \$20 billion to shareholders, boosted dividends, unveiled its Vera Rubin AI platform, and forecast Q2 revenue of \$91 billion.

AMD commits US\$10 billion in Taiwan

Advanced Micro Devices (AMD) plans to invest over US\$10 billion in Taiwan's

AI sector to strengthen partnerships across the semiconductor supply chain and expand AI chip production. AMD will collaborate with ASE Technology Holding, SPIL, and other Taiwanese firms on energy-efficient technologies to support its 2nm Venice CPUs.

Analog Devices nears \$1.5 billion acquisition of Empower Semiconductor

Analog Devices is reportedly nearing a \$1.5 billion all-cash acquisition of Empower Semiconductor. The deal would strengthen Analog Devices' position in the fast-growing power management market, particularly for AI, cloud, and data-centre applications. Empower's energy-efficient voltage-regulator technology could enhance power delivery, efficiency, and competitiveness in next-generation computing systems.

Google places AI chip manufacturing order with Intel

Google has reportedly agreed to have Intel produce over three million AI tensor processing units in 2028. The deal could significantly boost Intel Foundry's contract manufacturing business and strengthen US-based chip production. It also supports Google's strategy to reduce reliance on Nvidia GPUs.

Nvidia and SK hynix deepen partnership for AI memory

Nvidia and SK hynix have formed a multiyear partnership to develop next-generation memory technologies for AI infrastructure. The collaboration covers future Nvidia platforms, including Vera Rubin, and also uses AI, digital twins, and Omniverse-based tools to enhance semiconductor design, simulation, and factory automation.

Rapidus launches AI-based 2nm chip design tools

Rapidus Corporation has launched AI-based chip design tools for its 2nm process, targeting semiconductor engineers, ASIC developers, SoC architects, RTL designers, and chip design teams.

The tools generate RTL code, analyse and improve designs, estimate power, performance and area (PPA), identify issues, and shorten development time. Rapidus says they can reduce design time by up to 50% and costs by up to 30%. The company plans to launch Raads Navigator for design reviews, Raads Manager for physical design, and Raads Optimizer for PPA optimisation.

Cadence introduces AI 'virtual engineer' for chips

Cadence has introduced an AI-powered 'virtual engineer' that performs chip design and verification tasks with minimal human intervention. By extending its AI-driven EDA platform, the system can plan tasks, run simulations, analyse results, and optimise workflows autonomously. Designed for AI, data centre, automotive, and computing applications, it aims to accelerate verification and reduce time-to-silicon.

Synopsys expands support for advanced chip design

Synopsys has expanded its AI-powered chip design, verification, testing, and IP portfolio for Samsung Foundry's latest processes. The update adds AI-driven digital and analogue design flows for Samsung's third-generation 2nm technology, enhanced sign-off tools, expanded design-for-test (DFT) and automatic test pattern generation (ATPG) capabilities, and support for hybrid copper-bonding-based 3DIC development targeting AI, HPC, and multi-die devices.

Applied Materials targets 2nm designs

Applied Materials has introduced three semiconductor manufacturing systems for deposition, etching, and materials modification to improve transistor performance and power efficiency at 2nm and future nodes using Gate-All-Around architectures for AI and HPC chips. Its Producer Viva radical treatment platform enhances silicon nanosheet surface quality, boosting electron mobility and switching speed, and reducing copper interconnect resistance.